

Comp34612 Group Project Marking Schemes

Section 1. Approach Mark

The approach mark is assessed by the lecturers based on the presentation which is given during the last week of the semester, and what is described on the group journal. **The approach mark counts 50% of your project mark, in which the project presentation counts 40% and the journal counts 10%.**

1.1. Presentation Marking Scheme

For your presentation, we are interested in how the choices you made in designing and improving your codes were informed by the following.

- **Good understanding of the methods used:** We don't want you to produce a course on what we taught you. We want to see evidence in what you implement and what decisions you make that you understand the methods you are using.
- **Use of the lecture material or literature:** Was the system you built and the choices you made informed by work found in the teaching material and literature? Certainly, use the material and literature outside the lecture materials are more encouraged.
- **Use of evidence and experiments:** Did you do careful testing or comparative tests to choose parameters, evaluate approaches, etc. Did you show us the outcomes of these?
- **Novel thinking of your approach and extra feature to the implementation:** Did you think, develop, and implement any approach beyond the teaching materials? What are the experiments and conclusions you reach for this extra approach or implementation?

Based on the above items, the details of the marking scheme are

1. Unjustified absence: 0 marks
2. No understanding of the task; little progress — up to 40%
3. Weak understanding with decent progress on a straight-forward method, or reasonable understanding but no progress — 50% – 60%.
4. Solid understanding of a standard method, and a straight-forward implementation — 60% – 70%.
5. Excellent understanding of a standard method, or reasonable understanding of an advanced method, or standard method with extra components well-motivated by the literature. 70% – 80%
6. Exceptional and comprehensive approach to a standard method or a good implementation of an advanced method — > 80%

In addition, there are extra value marks for adding novel thinking of the approach and extra features to the implementation — 5% per extra component up to 20%.

1.2. Journal Marking Scheme

As the journal only counts 10% of your project mark, we would like a freer style of journal rather than a fixed set of criteria, you can include:

- **You organise your project activities** such as your project plan, your project activities, and your task distribution among your group members.
- **Your journal from the start to the end of the project** such as progress report, the descriptions of the methods you chose and the ideas of the implementation /testing /evaluation, any discussion and decision among your group members during the project, any difficulties you faced and how to you overcome these difficulties.
- **Your reflective of the project** such as what you feel that you have done good or bad, would you do differently if you had another chance, any work you would do if you had more time, and any feedback to this project style of coursework and what aspects you would like us to improve.
- **Any other thing you would like to tell us.**

Based on the above items, the details of the marking scheme are

1. Unjustified absence: 0 marks
2. Very limited work. Little evidence of planning, progress, or reflection. Minimal detail, missing large parts of the required elements. Work is incomplete or superficial - Below 40%
3. 50–59% (Pass):
4. Basic work showing some attempt at planning, journaling, and reflection. Limited depth or detail, but the basic requirements are addressed. Some parts may be vague, unbalanced, or underdeveloped -50–59%
5. Clear and competent work covering most requirements. Reasonable planning and organisation, some useful journal entries and reflections. Evidence of thought, but limited critical insight or creativity - 60–69%
6. Well-structured and detailed work. Good evidence of planning, consistent progress recording, and thoughtful reflection. Challenges and decisions are discussed clearly. Some creativity or originality is shown - 70–79%.
7. Comprehensive, insightful, and very well-presented work. Strong evidence of careful planning, detailed progress journal, and deep, critical reflection. Clear evaluation of decisions and methods, with creativity and originality beyond requirements - 80–100%

Section 2. Performance Mark

The performance mark counts the other 50% of your project mark.

For your submission, you can either submit one leader to play with three different followers, or you can submit three different leaders in which each leader plays to a corresponding follower respectively, as far as you tell us which leader to play which follower in your submitted readme file.

Calculation of your performance mark is summarised as follows:

- **Step 1.** We will run your submitted codes against MK1, MK2, and MK3 and get the accumulated profit for the days 101 – 130. These profits will be used as the performance of your submitted codes against MK1, MK2 and MK3

- **Step 2.** We have also designed 3 further followers MK4, MK5, and MK6, which are created by slightly changes of the parameters of MK1, MK2, and MK3 respectively. That is, MK1 and MK4 are very similar, MK2 and MK5 are very similar, MK3 and MK6 are very similar. No data about MKi (i=4,5,6) is provided. That is, they are invisible followers to you. But the setting of each MKi (i=4,5,6) is the same as the provided followers, with 100 historical data and we will run your codes to get the accumulated profit for days 101 – 130, which will be used as the performance of your submitted codes against MK4, MK5 and MK6.
- **Step 3.** For playing against MK1 and MK 4, your code will receive a percentage mark based on the accumulated profits for MK1 and MK4, compared to the best possible performances for MK1 and MK4. That is,

$$\text{Percentage Mark} = \frac{\text{Your accumulated profit}}{\text{The best possible accumulated profit}} \times 100\%$$

Similarly, your code will get a percentage mark for playing against Mk2 and Mk5, and then a percentage mark for playing against Mk3 and Mk6. Finally, your performance mark will be the average of these 3 percentage marks.

Section 3. Group Mark Distribution

The overall group mark will be allocated to individual group members based on the self-assessment and the demonstration of knowledge during the presentation.

The demonstration of knowledge during the presentation:

In most cases, the presentation mark for each member of a group will be the same. However, if someone contributes little or says nothing during the presentation, his/her mark will be lower than his/her group. This will be judged by the lecturers based on each group's presentation.

Self-assessment (which will impact your performance and journal mark):

After the project submission deadline at 6:00pm on 2nd May, I will send you an email as the one given in Appendix, in which I will ask you to send me your contribution assessment among your group's members, if you think that the contributions between the member of your group are significantly uneven. Please do not send them to me before the end of the project, as this can only be assessed fairly after the end of the project.

Section 4. A summary of the marking and moderation process

- **Presentation marking** (40% of the coursework mark): Both the lecturers of the module will listen to each project group's presentation and then sit together to discuss and give the mark of the presentation based on the marking scheme above.
- **Journal marking** (10% of the coursework mark):: The unit leader will read the journal report from each group, and then does the marking based on the marking scheme above.
- **Performance mark** (50% of the coursework mark): The GTAs will run the submitted codes from each group and then get the performance figures. To ensure the correctness of the running

of the students' codes, the leading GAT, who implemented the software tool to run the students' codes, will rerun a 20% of the codes run by the other GTAs and check the consistency and correctness. Once all codes are run and the performance figures are submitted to the unit leader, he will give the marking for each group based on marking scheme above.

- **Individual mark:** The unit leader will collect the contribution report from each member of a project group (no report is needed if the contribution of each member of the group is roughly same), and then average the contribution ratio scores to get each individual student's contribution ratio score, which times the group's mark to get the final individual mark.

Appendix

As a part of the marking, I need your feedback whether you believe that each member's mark in your group should be unevenly distributed (for example, one member makes little contribution).

If you think that each member's mark in your group should be evenly distributed, then you need to do nothing.

If you do believe that each member's mark in your group should be unevenly distributed, then please let me know by email (x.zeng@manchester.ac.uk) that **the percentage of each member's contribution to your group project is**, in the format as the example below and with **the deadline on 6 May**.

Group 28:

Member 1: 30%; Member 2: 30%; Member 3: 30%; Member 4: 10%

Reason: Member 4 has participated few activities for the project except the project presentation and made only a little contribution to the project codes.

I cannot guarantee to do the marking exactly based on your feedback. Remember that your group is a team, and each member has to do their part. You should not concern too much whether one member's contribution is slightly bigger or smaller than another, but focus more on whether everyone has similarly engaged in your group project. However, if a member of your group did not do their part for whatever reason, I would like to know in order to give the fair mark to everyone in your group.